

Mentorship Guide – GSMA MENA Ignite Hackathon

Mentorship Rules and Guidelines for Hackathon Participants

Mentorship sessions are provided to help shortlisted teams sharpen their idea, validate technical direction, and improve execution quality. Mentors are available between 28th August and 10th September 2026. These sessions are structured, time-bound, and governed by the rules below.

Failure to follow these guidelines may result in loss of mentorship support.

1. Assigned Mentor (Mandatory)

- Each team is assigned one designated mentor.
- Teams must engage only with their assigned mentor.
- Contacting other mentors for guidance is not permitted.

2. Single Mentorship Session Limit

- Each team may seek guidance from their assigned mentor either through a scheduled online session or offline via email, as appropriate.
- Each team is entitled to one (1) mentorship session only.
- No follow-up, extension, or second session will be granted.
- Teams are expected to come fully prepared to maximise value from this single interaction.

3. Scheduling Is the Team's Responsibility

- Mentor session must be completed before end of day 10th September 2026.
- The organizing team will not schedule sessions on your behalf.
- Teams must contact their assigned mentor directly to:
 - Confirm availability
 - Agree on a mutually suitable time
- Delayed outreach or failure to schedule on time is the team's responsibility.
- In cases where a live session cannot be scheduled due to the availability of either the team or the mentor, teams are encouraged to seek guidance offline via email.

4. Session Duration (Strictly Enforced)

- Each mentorship session must be limited to 30 minutes.
- Sessions exceeding this timeframe may be terminated by the mentor.

- Mentors are supporting multiple teams and strict time discipline is required.

5. Professional Conduct and Courtesy

- Mentors are volunteering their time and expertise.
- Teams are expected to:
 - Reach out early
 - Be flexible on scheduling
 - Be punctual
 - Communicate clearly and respectfully
- Unprepared or disorganized sessions reflect poorly on the team and reduce the value of the interaction.

6. Mandatory Preparation Requirements

Teams must be prepared to:

- Present a clear, concise overview of their idea (2–3 minutes max)
- Clearly articulate:
 - The problem being solved
 - The target users
 - The current state of the prototype or concept
- Clearly define what guidance is being requested, such as:
 - System architecture
 - CAMARA / Network API usage
 - Execution feasibility
 - Scalability or deployment considerations
- Bring specific, focused questions
 - Open-ended or vague requests will be deprioritized

7. What Mentors Will and Will Not Do

What Mentors Will Do

- Provide strategic guidance on:
 - Idea refinement
 - Technical architecture

- API usage patterns
- Execution risks and trade-offs
- Challenge assumptions and highlight gaps
- Offer feedback grounded in real-world deployment experience
- Help teams focus on what matters most for the hackathon

What Mentors Will NOT Do

- Write or debug your code
- Design your full system end-to-end
- Validate business models or funding strategies beyond the hackathon scope
- Review or iterate on multiple versions of your idea
- Act as ongoing advisors beyond the single scheduled session
- Make decisions on behalf of the team

Mentorship is advisory, not delivery. Final design, implementation, and decisions remain the responsibility of the team.

Final Note

Mentorship is a limited, high-value resource. Teams that arrive prepared, focused, and disciplined will gain the most. Teams that treat mentorship as a brainstorming or exploratory session may leave with little actionable guidance.

Use the time and support from mentors wisely.